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Report Name: Oilseeds and Products Annual

Country: Tunisia

Post: Tunis

Report Category: Oilseeds and Products

Prepared By:

Approved By: Benjamin Rau

Report Highlights:

Tunisian MY 2025/26 soybean imports are expected to reach 535,000 MT, compared to 530,000 MT in MY 2024/25 as demand for animal feed increases slightly. Tunisian olive oil exports are forecast to drop to 180,000 MT in MY 2025/26, compared to 280,000 MT in MY 2024/25 reflecting the alternating high and low fruit bearing cycle of olive production.

OILSEEDS SECTION:

Table1: Soybean Production, Supply and Distribution

Oilseed, Soybean Market Year Begins Tunisia	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	Post Estimate
Area Planted (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	35	35	15	42	47
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	520	520	550	530	535
Total Supply (1000 MT)	555	555	565	572	582
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Crush (1000 MT)	460	433	450	440	450
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	80	80	100	85	90
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	540	513	550	525	540
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	15	42	15	47	42
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	555	555	565	572	582

Area Harvested/Production: Tunisia does not produce soybeans. Although the Ministry of Agriculture encourages Tunisian producers to diversify into rapeseed and sunflower crops, there are no formal programs to support diversification. As a result, Tunisian oilseed production is focused on the olive industry.

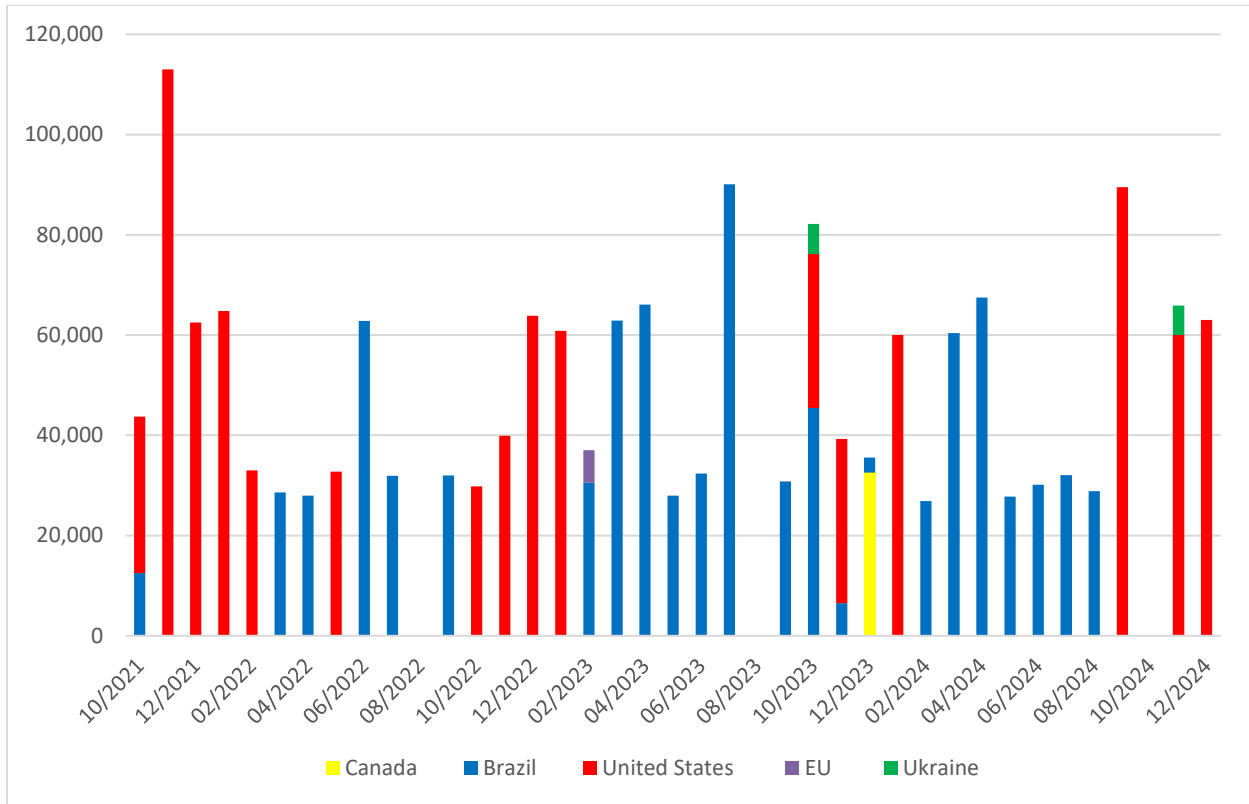
Consumption: For MY 2025/26, Post expects Tunisia's crushing facility demand to slightly increase compared to MY 2024/25 and MY 2023/24. This is due in part to an anticipated small increase in Tunisia's food service sector due to an anticipated increase in tourism, (a significant poultry, beef, and dairy consumer). Soybean total consumption in MY 2023/24 is lowered because of lower crush in MY 2023/24 as some domestic crushing was displaced by imports of soybean meal. Tunisian feed millers report that the industry directed soybeans to the production of full fat soybean and express soybean meal (direct feed use) in MY 2023/24, and this will increase slightly in MY 2024/25 and MY 2025/26 as production capacities and demand for full fat soybean and express soybean meal has stabilized. Post decreases soybean crush to reflect industry's final number for MY 2023/24.

Stocks: Industry strives to maintain at least 30 processing days of storage, or about 45,000 MT. Industry sources also confirm ending stocks in MY 2023/24 were 42,000 MT.

Trade: Post maintained the MY 2023/24 import based on revised and finalized trade numbers. Change to the MY 2024/25 import estimate reflects estimated crush and consumption decrease. The MY 2025/26 import forecast reflects an anticipated increase in consumption compared to MY 2024/25. Tunisia imports soybeans from Brazil, U.S., Canada, Ukraine, and the U.E.

Tunisian importers typically import based on price and availability. However, Tunisia's soybean crusher reports their satisfaction with U.S. soybean quality and has stated their willingness to pay a premium for U.S. soybean over products from competing origins even when prices slightly lower from other origins.

Figure 1: Soybean Exports to Tunisia (MT)



MEALS SECTION:

Table 2: Soybean Meal Production, Supply and Distribution

Meal, Soybean Market Year Begins Tunisia	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	Post Estimate
Crush (1000 MT)	460	433	450	440	450
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.7957	0.7945	0.7956	0.7932	0.7911
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	16	16	12	11	15
Production (1000 MT)	366	344	358	349	356
MY Imports (1000 MT)	120	120	135	135	145
Total Supply (1000 MT)	502	480	505	495	516
MY Exports (1000 MT)	10	10	10	10	10
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	480	459	480	470	483
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	480	459	480	470	483
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	12	11	15	15	23
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	502	480	505	495	516

Production: No significant changes are currently seen or expected in extraction rates. Soybean meal production and ending stocks in MY 2023/24 are revised lower based on industry final production reports.

Consumption: In MY 2023/24 Post decreased soybean meal consumption to balance production and ending stocks industry final numbers. Post estimates soybean meal consumption to increase in MY 2024/2025 and in 2025/2026 compared to MY 2023/24. This increase reflects the assumption of continued increase in the tourism industry's demand for meat products and assuming normal population growth. However, growth is expected to be restrained by inflationary pressures that will minimize domestic, non-tourist, demand. Note that 70 percent of soybean meal is destined for the poultry and egg sectors.

Table 3: Meals on a Soybean Meal Equivalent Basis

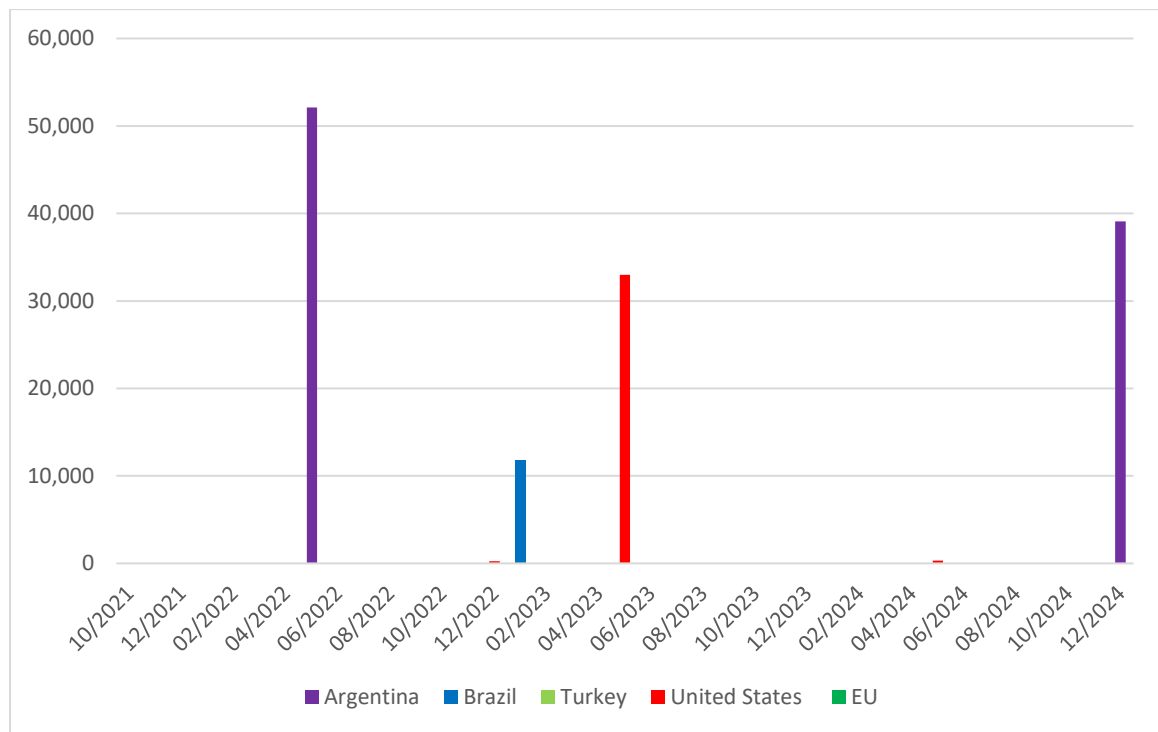
Meals on a Soybean Meal Equivalent Basis (1,000 MT)					
	Description	Conversion Factor	Marketing Year		
			2021/22	2022/23	2023/24
Production			325.3	340.5	351.2
	Soybean Meal ⁽¹⁾	1	321	334	344
	Fish Meal ⁽²⁾	1.445	4.3	6.5	7.2
Imports			177.9	138.7	131.5
	Soybean Meal ⁽¹⁾	1	164	115	120
	DDGS ⁽³⁾	0.58	9.3	18.3	7.6
	CGM & CGF ⁽³⁾	0.68	2.6	3.6	1.7
	Fish Meal ⁽³⁾	1.445	2	1.8	2.2
	Others ⁽³⁾	0.4515	0	0	0
Exports			10.2	11	12.3
	Soybean Meal ⁽¹⁾	1	10	10	10
	Fish Meal ⁽³⁾	1.445	0.2	1	2.3
Balance			493	468.2	470.4

Source: (1) PSD, (2) Industry, (3) Source: Trade Data Monitor, LLC derived data by calculating imports/exports by exporters or importers.

Stocks: Tunisia's feed mills and crushing facility each target 30 days of soybean meal stocks. Post decreases soybean meal ending stocks to reflect industry's final number for MY 2023/24. In MY 2024/25 Post maintained soybean meal ending stocks.

Trade: Soybean meal imports in MY 2025/26 are forecast to slightly increase compared to MY 2024/25 to accommodate a projected small consumption increase.

Figure 2: Soybean Meal Exports to Tunisia (MT)



Source: Trade Data Monitor, LLC

OILS SECTION:

Table 4: Olive Oil Production, Supply and Distribution

Oil, Olive Market Year Begins Tunisia	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026
	Nov 2023		Nov 2024		Nov 2025
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	Post Estimate
Area Planted (1000 HA)	2000	2000	2000	2060	2100
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	0	2000	0	2060	2100
Trees (1000 TREES)	96000	96000	96000	98880	100800
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	14	14	11	11	43
Production (1000 MT)	220	220	280	340	200
MY Imports (1000 MT)	2	2	2	2	2
Total Supply (1000 MT)	236	236	293	353	245
MY Exports (1000 MT)	200	200	220	280	180
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	25	25	30	30	25
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	25	25	30	30	25
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	11	11	43	43	40
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	236	236	293	353	245

Table 5: Soybean Oil Production, Supply and Distribution

Oil, Soybean Market Year Begins Tunisia	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	Post Estimate
Crush (1000 MT)	460	433	450	440	450
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.1848	0.1871	0.1844	0.1886	0.1867
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	14	14	10	13	18
Production (1000 MT)	85	81	83	83	84
MY Imports (1000 MT)	26	26	90	35	36
Total Supply (1000 MT)	125	121	183	131	138
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	115	108	165	113	117
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	115	108	165	113	117
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	10	13	18	18	21
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	125	121	183	131	138

Table 6: Palm Oil Production, Supply and Distribution

Oil, Palm Market Year Begins Tunisia	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	Post Estimate
Area Planted (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0
Trees (1000 TREES)	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	11	11	11	11	13
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	80	80	85	85	87
Total Supply (1000 MT)	91	91	96	96	100
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	80	80	85	83	85
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	80	80	85	83	85
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	11	11	11	13	15
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	91	91	96	96	100

Production: MY 2025/26 olive oil production is forecast at 200,000 MT, reflecting the alternating high fruit bearing cycle which had high production in MY 2024/25. Post currently estimates MY 2024/25 production at 340,000 MT, based on official and industry sources. The 2024/25 harvest is ongoing (October 2024 - February 2025). Tunisia's olive area accounts for one-third of the country's total arable land, and area is expected to continue increasing in coming years (see policy section). The bulk of the olive harvest is processed into various grades of oil by 850 private olive mills scattered throughout the production area.

Soybean oil production in MY 2023/24 is revised lower based on industry-reported final data. In 2024/25 soybean oil production is maintained to reflect an increase in crushing compared to MY 2023/24 with an estimated stable extraction rate.

Consumption: Given current policies, Post does not see significant changes to per capita consumption of soybean or palm oil. Soybean and corn oil are the most popular cooking oils with prices subsidized by the government to ensure their affordability on the retail market (see policy section). Palm oil is not well perceived by consumers and is generally limited to the food manufacturing sector.

Stocks: Industry sources confirm soybean oil ending stocks in MY 2023/24 were 13,000 MT.

Table 7: Total Vegetable Oil Food Use

Total Non-Olive Vegetable Oil Food Use (1,000 MT)				
	Description	Marketing Year		
		2021/22	2022/23	2023/24
Production	Non-Olive Veg Oil	75	82	81
	Soybean Oil ⁽¹⁾	75	82	81
Imports ⁽²⁾	Non-Olive Veg Oil	222	212	165
	Soybean Oil	76	65	26
	Sunflower Oil	20	19	28
	Corn Oil	34	34	41
	Palm Oil	79	75	56
	Copra Oil	8	4	9
	Rapeseed	0	9	0
	Palm Kernel Oil	5	6	5
Exports ⁽²⁾	Non-Olive Veg Oil	0	0	0
	Soybean Oil	0	0	0
Balance	Non-Olive Veg Oil	297	294	246

Source: (1) PSD, (2) Trade Data Monitor, LLC derived data by calculating imports/exports by exporters or importers.

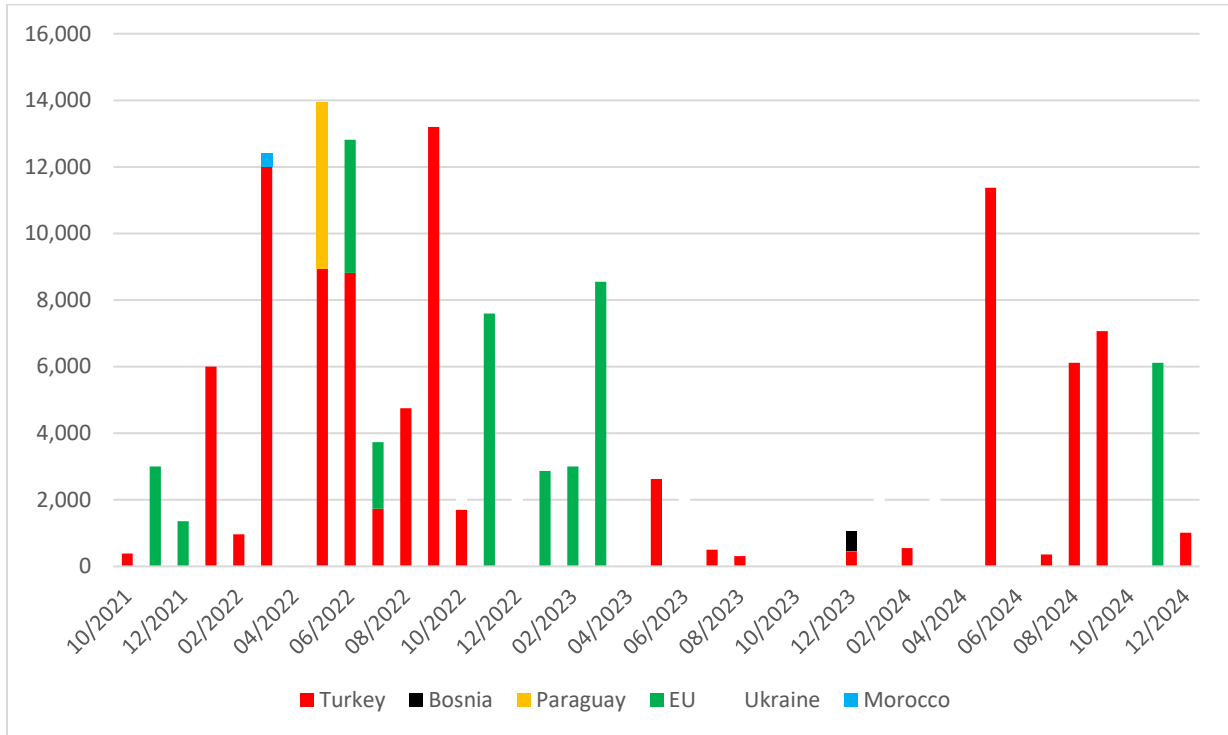
Domestic olive oil prices have decreased for local consumers due to larger production in MY 2024/25. The average domestic price for Tunisian olive oil is currently \$4.37 per liter, compared to \$6.75 the same time last year. In MY 2024/25, Tunisia has marketed locally some olive oil at a subsidized price of \$3.75 per liter (see policy section). In MY 2025/26 olive oil consumption is forecast to slightly decrease compared to MY 2024/25 and to reach the same level recorded in MY 2023/24 following almost a same total supply.

Trade: Tunisia's primary export markets for olive oil are Europe and the United States (61 percent and 28 percent respectively), with 16 percent of total production sold in bottles in MY 2023/24. However, the volume of bottled olive oil exports is increasing, as per the government priority to substitute more lucrative sales of branded product in place of bulk exports to intermediary processors in the EU. Most exports are facilitated by the National Oil Board (ONH).

Soybean oil imports in MY 2024/25 is lowered because of a higher beginning stock and to accommodate a slight increase in the total domestic consumption in MY 2024/25 compared to MY 2023/24.

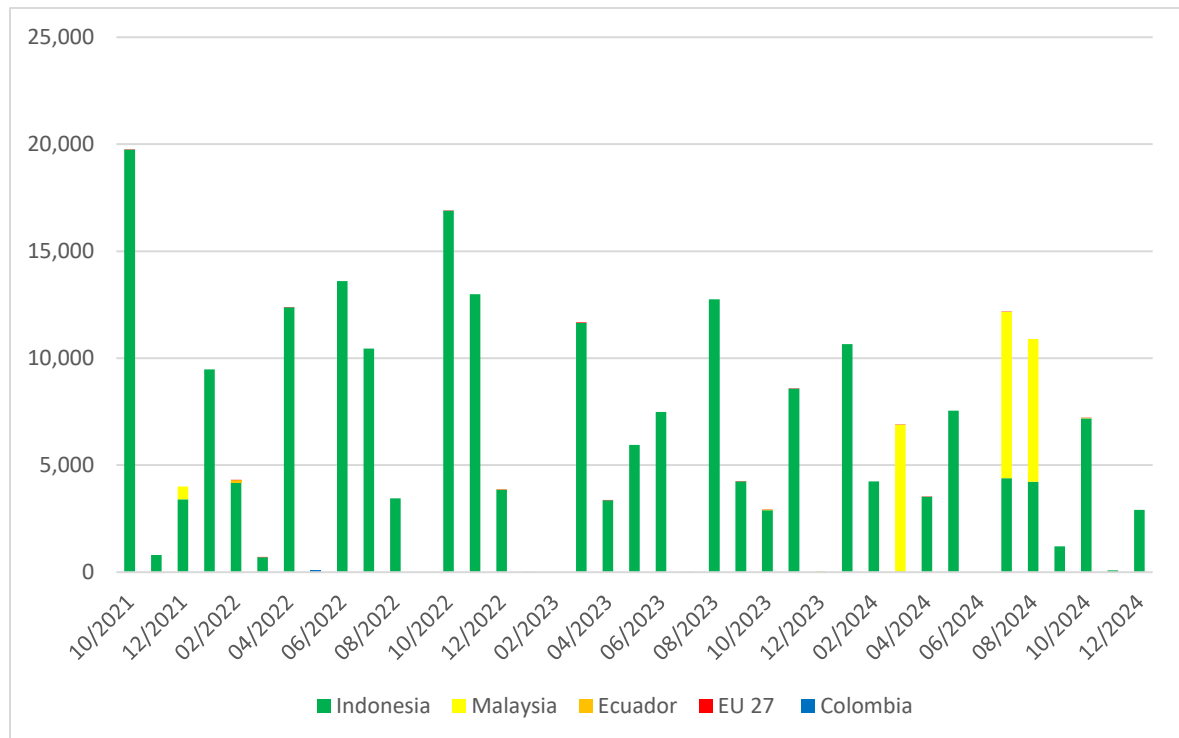
Soybean oil is Tunisia's largest vegetable oil import, followed by palm, corn, and sunflower oils. Soybean, sunflower, and corn oil are imported crude, as supported by an advantageous tax structure (see policy section below). However, palm oil is generally imported refined. Most refined corn oil and significant volumes of refined soybean oil are then re-exported. While Libya is a major buyer of Tunisia's refined and price-controlled vegetable oils, exact export volumes are difficult to estimate.

Figure3: Soybean Oil Exports to Tunisia (MT)



Source: Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Figure 4: Palm Oil Exports to Tunisia (MT)



Source: Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Policy: There have been no major changes in vegetable oil policy, and Tunisia maintains the following key objectives with regards to the sector:

1. To increase annual average production of olive oil from 205,000 MT to 250,000 MT by 2030 through (1) an aging olive tree renewal plan (representing 20 percent of olive trees) and (2) plans for new plantations in northwest Tunisia,
2. To increase olive trees yields from a low average of 0.1 MT of olive oil per hectare to no less than 0.12 MT per hectare through improvement of olive tree cultivation techniques and a national olive disease protection program,
3. To mitigate the large disparity of olive oil production during drought years, the government targets increasing irrigated area of olive trees from 130,000 HA to 170,000 HA. (Droughts occur two out of every five years on average). Expansion of irrigation would increase olive oil production from irrigated orchards to 140,000 MT and guarantee a minimum level of production during drought years,
4. To make a portion of olive oil affordable for Tunisians, in MY 2024/25, for the second time, Tunisia has marketed 600 MT of olive oil at a subsidized price of \$3.75 per liter.
5. To promote olive oil exports, a major source of the country's hard currency earnings.
6. To fulfill most of the domestic demand for imported vegetable oils at the lowest cost possible,
7. To continue subsidizing vegetable oil purchased by the state-run National Oil Board (ONH) to maintain relatively low market prices at the retail level [note: the Compensation Fund (Caisse Generale de Compensation) writes off losses incurred by ONH resulting from selling at prices below purchase costs],
8. To transition vegetable oil imports from ONH to private-run refiners via a refining quota system.

To maintain affordable prices of vegetable oils for consumers, the government continues to maintain reduced taxes and VAT on a list of edible oils (e.g., palm, soybean, corn, and sunflower) through the application of Decree 2014-002 of January 7, 2014.

Table 8: Custom Duties and Value Added Taxes on Vegetable Oils

Products	Custom Duties %	Value Added Taxes
Peanut Oil - Crude	0	0
Peanut Oil - Refined	10	0
Palm Oil - Crude	0	0
Palm Oil - Refined	10	0
Sunflower Oil - Crude	0	0
Sunflower Oil - Refined	10	0
Rapeseed Oil - Crude	0	0
Rapeseed Oil - Refined	10	0

Corn Oil - Crude	0	0
Corn Oil - Refined	10	0
Soybean Oil – Crude	0	0
Soybean Oil - Refined	10	0

Attachments:

No Attachments